

C3 Complement (RDL)

Test Details

METHODOLOGY

Turbidimetry

RESULT TURNAROUND TIME

5 - 7 days

Turnaround time is defined as the usual number of days from the date of pickup of a specimen for testing to when the result is released to the ordering provider. In some cases, additional time should be allowed for additional confirmatory or additional reflex tests. Testing schedules may vary.

Test Includes

This test is a component of ANA Profile 11, ANA Profile 12, ANA 12 Plus Profile, Vasculitis Panel.

Use

Measurement of C3 is used to detect individuals with inborn deficiency of this factor or those with immunologic disease in whom complement is consumed at an increased rate. These include lupus erythematosus, chronic active hepatitis, certain chronic infections, post-streptococcal and membranoproliferative glomerulonephritis, and others.

Specimen Requirements

Specimen

Serum

Volume

1 mL

Minimum Volume

0.3 mL (**Note:** This volume does **not** allow for repeat testing.)

Container

Gel tube or red-top tube

Collection Instructions

Separate serum from cells within one hour. Transfer to a plastic transport tube before freezing.

Stability Requirements

Temperature	Period
Room temperature	4 days
Refrigerated	8 days
Frozen	8 days
Freeze/thaw cycles	Stable x1

Storage Instructions

Store **frozen** or refrigerated.

Causes for Rejection

Grossly hemolyzed; bacterial contamination; lipemic, icteric, non-serum specimen types
